lookers in New Zealand, which means you tend to spoil the ones you manage to lay eyes on. For a few days anyway. And this isn't just my opinion – a lot of the players will tell you that the quality there is not great, hey.

My most expensive 'date', ever

It was the 1999 tour to New Zealand, the final Test in Wellington, and my teammate Dale Benkenstein's birthday. This was a very successful tour for the Proteas. We did well out on the pitch too, winning the ODI series 3-2 and the Test series 1-0. As a team we scored over 1 500 runs in only four innings, and that fourth innings was only to get the 16 runs we needed to win the third Test.

In the first Test, in Auckland, Daryll Cullinan broke the record for the highest South African Test score with 275. (Gary Kirsten would, of course, famously equal that score 10 months later against England, before Graeme Smith would raise it to 277, also against the Poms, in 2003.) I was in good nick as well on that tour, scoring 211 in the second Test and 120 in the third.

Anyway, it was Benky's birthday on the Saturday night, the third day of the Test, and I was fresh off my century in our first innings, so I thought I'd let my hair down a little – so to speak – and enjoy his birthday with him. A few Proteas were also with us – I remember Nicky Bojé being one – but it was still obviously a Test night. The understanding with team management was that we could go out on a match night, as long as things didn't get out of hand. Right. So cool, out we went and, as is often the case, one thing led to another, and then took a further step that eventually left me R5 000 poorer.

I happened to see this particularly beautiful girl walk into the pub where we were having a few toots, and I think, like most of us do when we've had a few, I was feeling anything but shy. I decided to go straight in for the kill. I don't remember what I said to her – I was pretty juiced up – but whatever it was, it worked. It didn't take more than a minute and a half – dead serious – and the game was on. We left the bar to go to her place. To this day Nicky claims it is the quickest pick-up he's ever seen in his life.

When I combine my gift of the gab with a few drinks, things tend to happen very quickly. As I said, I can't for the life of me remember what I said, but she bought it right then and there. Unfortunately, memory loss is an issue when I drink heavily – especially if I drink a lot of shooters. They